



Harnessing 3ds max 5

A journey through 3ds max

Inspired by *Matrix Reloaded*, and Leager to try animation? Of all the 3D graphics software, 3ds max has traditionally been the beginners' choice. The beauty of *Harnessing 3ds max 5* lies in its emphasis on basics. It begins with a chapter covering the nitty-gritty of 3D, followed by an introduction to 3ds max. Its interface and usage is explained thereafter.

Rendering and special effects, in 3ds max, can be easily learnt. However, the same cannot be said about modelling fundamentals, which require a detailed understanding. The book covers this



exhaustively; the chapter on 3D modelling is the largest. There is even a chapter on advanced modelling towards the end. Concepts such as modifier stack—one of the core features of 3ds max—have been explained in detail. The book then picks up pace, and explains concepts regarding materials, cameras and rendering. The explanations provided are well aided by illustrations and screenshots. A summary and

an exercise, provided at the end of each chapter, help you to fully understand the content.

The accompanying CD complements the book by including videos that explain the software's key features. Files for doing the exercises given in the book, are also included.

Although the book has done full justice of guiding a beginner to the intermediate level, it could have done better by touching on some advanced topics such as network rendering. Also, no introduction has been given to plug-ins such as character studio, combustion and reactor. It also does not come across as a book meant for advanced users. But have no second thoughts. If you want to dive into 3ds max, then this is the book for you, provided you have deep pockets!

Publisher: Autodesk Press ■ **Author:** Aaron Ross and Michele Bousquet ■ **Distributor:** Computer Bookshop (India) Pvt Ltd ■ **Phone:** 022-22317922 ■ **Fax:** 022-22623551 ■ **E-mail:** orders@cb-india.com ■ **Web site:** www.cb-india.com ■ **Price:** Rs 1,150
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Google Hacks 100 Industrial-Strength Tips and Tricks

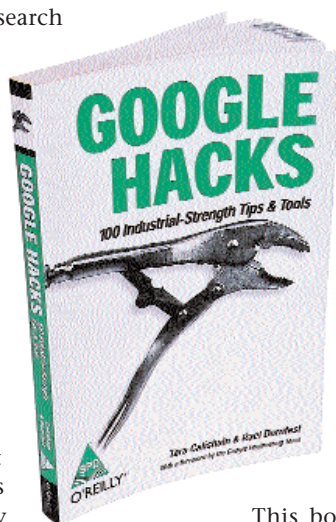
Search what you want...

Google is the undisputed king of search engines, and is your best bet to finding what you need on the Internet. The only problem is, if you don't search smart, you might get too many search results for general queries—a search for 'news' in Google throws up 237 million results. This book aims to help you conquer the art of searching.

The book describes different ways to exploit the Google search system. These are referred to as 'hacks', they are described well and yield precise and minimal search results. The book first describes basic search mechanics and then explains in detail how to use special keywords to refine your results. However, not all parts of the book are described visually, and placing screenshots in some places would have made

the hacks easier to understand.

After the basic search tricks, the book also explains how to use special Google searches and services. It explains the Google Groups and Directory searches. It also talks about upcoming search techniques, found in Google Labs. After this, the book explains how to use the Google API. It also lists out various useful third party applications made



using Google services. A final topic of interest is the Webmasters view to Google. It explains how to improve your Websites score in the famous Google Pagerank system.

For a more advanced user, the book provides program examples using the Google API. This is very useful if you want to use the Google search in a specific way. Many examples are provided which sort the results in different ways.

The language used in the book is simple to understand and the hacks work very well.

This book is a good buy at its price, especially if you are an avid researcher.

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